A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

13 May 2026

Dr Melanie Tait
Myhealth St Helena

Dear Dr Tait,

Re: Miss Kelly MacDonald
DOB: 29/12/1984 Phone: 0411 642 648
Address: 8 Elloura Avenue, WOLLERT, VIC, 3750
Email: yesitismekelly@gmail.com

Summary

- **Crohn's disease currently managed with Steqeyma.**
- **Greasy stools requiring evaluation for fat malabsorption.**
- **Debilitating back pain, migraines, and drenching night sweats; likely non-gastrointestinal in origin.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of conducting a telehealth review with Kelly. Her clinical picture is currently quite complex, and she describes what she identifies as a "mixed bag" of symptoms that are significantly impacting her quality of life and ability to work. Kelly's primary concern is an intense, localised lower back pain that radiates up her spine to the base of her skull, which she feels flares in conjunction with her bowel movements. This is associated with daily, debilitating migraines and profound fatigue that is unrefreshing despite long periods of sleep. Furthermore, she is experiencing drenching night sweats requiring multiple changes of clothes. She is currently taking Endone on a daily basis for pain, which she finds helpful for symptom control but is concerned about the long-term cognitive effects.

Regarding her gastrointestinal symptoms, her Crohn's disease appears relatively stable on Steqeyma, and I have provided her with a e-script for this. She did, however, report that her stools have a greasy, oily appearance. We discussed her history of endometriosis and her current Mirena, though she notes occasional episodes of sudden, heavy breakthrough bleeding.

Impression and Plan

I do not believe that her back pain, migraines, or night sweats are directly related to her inflammatory bowel disease. I noted that she has had recent spinal imaging which did not suggest ankylosing spondylitis. Given the greasy nature of her stools, I have requested a faecal elastase to formally assess for fat malabsorption. I have also ordered a suite of blood tests, including iron studies and B12, to investigate her fatigue, as she is certainly at risk for deficiency.

I have suggested to Kelly that she return to her pain specialist, Dr Clayton Thomas, to discuss non-pharmacological interventions for her back pain, as the current daily use of Endone is not an ideal long-term strategy. Given the night sweats and irregular bleeding, I have also asked her to discuss the

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possibility of perimenopause with you. I will review Kelly in six months' time, but I have invited her to contact my rooms sooner if there are any concerns regarding her iron or B12 status once the results are available.

Yours sincerely,

A/Prof Chamara Basnayake
Gastroenterologist

CC: Ms Helen Aharfi

All appointments and enquires
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Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065